

Jinxin Wu

Department of Economics, Georgetown University

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics

Georgetown University

2021 - 2027 (expected)

Washington, DC

Dissertation: Essays on Optimal Taxation and Public Spending

M.A. in International Economics

Johns Hopkins University, School of Advanced International Studies

2015 – 2017

Washington, DC

B.A. in Journalism

Fudan University

2006 – 2010

Shanghai, China

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Macroeconomics, Public Economics

Secondary: Fiscal Policy, Taxation

WORKING PAPERS

Optimal Defense Spending and Taxation Under Stochastic Threat *Job Market Paper*

This paper studies optimal defense spending and taxation in a dynamic economy in which public spending protects productive capital from destruction. Because the same capital stock can also be taxed to finance its protection, productive investment and protective investment are closely linked. The model implies that defense spending increases with destruction exposure when protection is active. When defense technology is sufficiently effective, greater destruction exposure can induce more protection and investment, allowing capital and output to recover, although this adaptation is costly. A Ramsey government can partially reproduce this response. Under discretion, anticipated taxation of installed capital reduces private investment, shrinks the capital base, and weakens defense. In the baseline calibration, lack of commitment generates a 1 percent consumption-equivalent welfare loss, and this loss increases with destruction exposure. The findings highlight the importance of fiscal institutions and policy credibility when the assets being protected are also an important source of tax revenue.

Propagation of Macroeconomic Shocks Through Input-Output and Geographic Networks in China (with Ergys Islamaj)

We study how sector-specific demand and supply shocks propagate through China's input-output and regional networks. Indirect network effects account for a substantial share of aggregate fluctuations, with inter-sectoral linkages representing roughly 30 percent of economic activity. The results highlight the central role of manufacturing and production networks in amplifying shocks across sectors and regions. The framework provides a tool for assessing the economy-wide impact of trade, productivity, and other sector-specific shocks

WORK IN PROGRESS

Temporary Spending or Lasting Growth? Government Procurement and Human Capital

This paper studies how the effectiveness of government spending varies across local economies. Matching granular U.S. defense procurement data and county-level labor market outcomes, I try to estimate local fiscal

effects and examine how spending composition shapes economic performance. Preliminary results suggest that technology-intensive procurement generates more persistent employment and income gains. The findings highlight the role of local absorptive capacity and human capital accumulation in fiscal transmission.

Effects of Elite Colleges Expanding Free Tuition (with Mihyun You)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The World Bank Group

Research Analyst, Prospects Group
VPU Team Award, 2021 and 2022

2017–2021

Washington, DC

- Developed forecasting models and provided analysis in flagship report *Global Economic Prospects and Commodity Markets Outlook*.
- Contributed to analytical research on global debt waves, commodity markets, production networks, and the informal economy.

Georgetown University

Research Assistant to Prof. Toshihiko Mukoyama and Prof. Xiang Ding

2022–2024

Washington, DC

- Assisted in compiling a global dataset on inter-sectoral capital service expenditures, enabling the construction of the first global input-output matrix of capital services.
- Constructed a firm-establishment-level panel dataset from multiple large-scale administrative datasets.

The Financial Times

Researcher, FT Confidential Research

2010–2014

Shanghai, China

- Authored the monthly *FT China Confidential* report and analyzed China's economic reforms, financial regulation, and capital markets.

POLICY PUBLICATIONS

- [“Propagation of Macroeconomic Shocks Through Input-Output and Geographic Networks in China,”](#) in *East Asia and Pacific Economic Update*, World Bank, April 2019, with Ergys Islamaj and Francesca de Nicola.
- [“Informal Economy in East Asia and Pacific,”](#) in *Global Economic Prospects*, World Bank, January 2019.
- [“Spillovers to Developing East Asia and Pacific from China,”](#) in *East Asia and Pacific Economic Update*, World Bank, October 2018, with Ergys Islamaj and Ekaterine T. Vashakmadze.
- [“Raw material commodity prices gain momentum amid stronger demand,”](#) World Bank, December 2020.
- [“Beverage commodity prices to stabilize amid stronger demand and ample supplies,”](#) World Bank, December 2020.
- [“Global food commodity prices in a post-COVID world,”](#) World Bank, November 2020.
- [“Food prices to edge up in 2019 but energy, trade, and foreign exchange could unsettle outlook,”](#) World Bank.
- [“Beverage prices weak on good crops and currency movements,”](#) World Bank.
- [“Raw materials outlook: Cotton, rubber prices to stabilize in 2019,”](#) World Bank.
- [“Food prices: Markets are well-supplied, but trade tensions, energy prices, and an Africa Swine Fever outbreak could create market instability,”](#) World Bank.
- [“Raw material prices to stabilize in 2019, make gains in 2020,”](#) World Bank.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Georgetown University

Instructor

2024 Summer, 2025 Summer

Intermediate Macroeconomics (teaching evaluation: 5 out of 5)

Graduate Teaching Assistant

2022–2026

International Finance; Intermediate Macroeconomics; Introduction to Econometrics; International Trade; Economic Analysis of Law

AWARDS

Graduate School Fellowship, Georgetown University

2021–2026

Department of Economics Summer Research Fellowship, Georgetown University

Summer 2024

National Merit Scholarship, Fudan University

2009

Tsang Hin Chi Scholarship, Fudan University

2009

Freshman Merit Scholarship, Fudan University

2006

PRESENTATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

ASSA 2027 Annual Meeting

2027*

Macro Seminar at Georgetown University

2026

Macroeconomics workshops at Georgetown University

2023–2026

5th Annual Macro Meetings at Georgetown (AMMEEGO) Conference

2025

SERVICE AND SKILLS

Co-chair, Georgetown Economics Graduate Student Organization

2024–2025

Computation: MATLAB, Python, R, Stata, EViews

Languages: Chinese (native), English (professional fluency)

REFERENCES

Toshihiko Mukoyama, co-advisor

Professor, Department of Economics

Georgetown University

tm1309@georgetown.edu

Axel Anderson, co-advisor

Professor, Department of Economics

Georgetown University

aza@georgetown.edu

Joshua Teitelbaum

David Belding Professor of Law, Law Center

Professor of Economics, Department of Economics

Georgetown University

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